VOICES OF THE LADDER · FAMILY LEARNING MORNING

Leader's guide
Grades K–2

Sunday, November 22 · Breakouts 10:00–10:30 · Thirty minutes Room _____

YOUR GROUP'S LINK

techrabbi.org/jacobs-ladder/voices/#k2

Type it on the laptop, or scan it with a phone.

> Every child leaves with a rung: one short line and a motion, to teach their family at the family ladders.
>
> *Rambam read the angels on Jacob's ladder as people who climb up to learn and come back down to teach (Guide for the Perplexed 1:15). This morning follows that shape: everyone climbs in their own group, then comes down to teach their family.*

YOUR THIRTY MINUTES

- **10:00** **Welcome.** Begin once everyone is settled, even before 10:00. Repeat the mission: each of you will bring back a rung for your family.
- **10:02** **Jacob.** Everyone starts here.
- **10:14** **A second visit.** Choose Esau, Rebekah, the angel, or the stone.

  Ahead of time? *If the second visit ends before 10:15, choose a third.*
- **10:25** **Our rungs.** Each child picks a rung and practices its motion.
- **10:30** **Family ladders.** Walk everyone to the multi-purpose room.

Each visit takes ten to twelve minutes and ends with its rung.

TIPS FOR GRADES K–2

- Read every line aloud, with feeling. Nobody needs to read.
- Do every motion with them, and stand up for the big ones.
- For a choice, let everyone call out, then press the number most of them chose.
- The pictures and animations are part of the story. Give them a moment.
- If energy dips, press Skip on a choice, or go to Our rungs a little early.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Reload the page: it keeps your place. Lost the page? Scan the code above or type the address. No internet? Tell the story in your own words; the rung key on every family table has each character's rung.

DRIVING THE LAPTOP

Space or →	The next line.
← ← Back	Back one step. Nothing is lost.
1–9	Choose the group's answer, or a question to ask.
Hear Jacob's answer	After the group has talked it over. Space works too.
Done asking →	When the group runs out of questions.
Genesis 28:12	Opens the source in Hebrew and English. Esc closes it.
Our rungs	Every rung your group heard. Practice together shows them large, one at a time.
Clear for the next group	Resets the laptop for another group. Tap it twice.

THE LAST FIVE MINUTES

Open Our rungs and tap Practice together. Say each rung together three times, with its motion. Then each child chooses the rung they will teach.

Send everyone to the family ladders with their rung.

BEFORE THE DAY

- [ ] Charge the laptop, and bring its charger.
- [ ] Open your link in your room ahead of time, to test the Wi-Fi.
- [ ] Turn off sleep and the screen saver.
- [ ] Full screen: F11 on Windows, Control-Command-F on a Mac.
- [ ] With a TV, check the words from the back row.
- [ ] Watch the five-minute walkthrough video, then try a visit.

Prepared by Rabbi Dan Medwin · Parashat Vayeitzei 5787

VOICES OF THE LADDER · FAMILY LEARNING MORNING

Leader's guide
Grades 3–4

Sunday, November 22 · Breakouts 10:00–10:30 · Thirty minutes Room _____

YOUR GROUP'S LINK

techrabbi.org/jacobs-ladder/voices/#g34

Type it on the laptop, or scan it with a phone.

> Every child leaves with a rung: a line and a secret, to teach their family at the family ladders.
>
> *Rambam read the angels on Jacob's ladder as people who climb up to learn and come back down to teach (Guide for the Perplexed 1:15). This morning follows that shape: everyone climbs in their own group, then comes down to teach their family.*

YOUR THIRTY MINUTES

- **10:00** **Welcome.** Begin once everyone is settled, even before 10:00. Repeat the mission: each of you will bring back a rung for your family.
- **10:02** **Jacob.** Everyone starts here.
- **10:14** **Rashi.** He solves the puzzle Jacob leaves you with: why do the angels go up first?

  Ahead of time? *If Rashi ends before 10:15, let the group choose Esau or the Sages.*
- **10:25** **Our rungs.** Each student chooses a rung, and its secret, to teach.
- **10:30** **Family ladders.** Walk everyone to the multi-purpose room.

Each visit takes ten to twelve minutes and ends with its rung.

TIPS FOR GRADES 3–4

- Invite strong readers to read a line aloud.
- Let the group argue before you choose an answer. Most choices have no wrong answer.
- Make a big deal of each secret. It is the part they will love telling at home.
- Tap a book button to show that an answer comes from a real text.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Reload the page: it keeps your place. Lost the page? Scan the code above or type the address. No internet? Tell the story in your own words; the rung key on every family table has each character's rung.

DRIVING THE LAPTOP

Space or →	The next line.
← ← Back	Back one step. Nothing is lost.
1–9	Choose the group's answer, or a question to ask.
Hear Jacob's answer	After the group has talked it over. Space works too.
Done asking →	When the group runs out of questions.
Genesis 28:12	Opens the source in Hebrew and English. Esc closes it.
Our rungs	Every rung your group heard. Practice together shows them large, one at a time.
Clear for the next group	Resets the laptop for another group. Tap it twice.

THE LAST FIVE MINUTES

Open Our rungs and tap Practice together. Say each rung together three times. Then each student chooses one rung, and its secret, to teach.

Send everyone to the family ladders with their rung.

BEFORE THE DAY

- ☐ Charge the laptop, and bring its charger.
- ☐ Open your link in your room ahead of time, to test the Wi-Fi.
- ☐ Turn off sleep and the screen saver.
- ☐ Full screen: F11 on Windows, Control-Command-F on a Mac.
- ☐ With a TV, check the words from the back row.
- ☐ Watch the five-minute walkthrough video, then try a visit.

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VOICES OF THE LADDER · FAMILY LEARNING MORNING

Leader's guide
Grades 5–7

Sunday, November 22 · Breakouts 10:00–10:30 · Thirty minutes Room _____

YOUR GROUP'S LINK

techrabbi.org/jacobs-ladder/voices/#g57

Type it on the laptop, or scan it with a phone.

> Every student leaves with a rung: a line and a question for their parents, to teach their family at the family ladders.
>
> *Rambam read the angels on Jacob's ladder as people who climb up to learn and come back down to teach (Guide for the Perplexed 1:15). This morning follows that shape: everyone climbs in their own group, then comes down to teach their family.*

YOUR THIRTY MINUTES

- **10:00** **Welcome.** Begin once everyone is settled, even before 10:00. Repeat the mission: each of you will bring back a rung for your family.
- **10:02** **Jacob.** Everyone starts here.
- **10:14** **A second visit.** Choose the Sages, Esau, Rashi, Ramban, or Rambam.

  Ahead of time? *If the second visit ends before 10:15, choose a third.*
- **10:25** **Our rungs.** Each student picks a rung and the question they will ask their parents.
- **10:30** **Family ladders.** Walk everyone to the multi-purpose room.

Each visit takes ten to twelve minutes and ends with its rung.

TIPS FOR GRADES 5–7

- For a debate, split the room and let both sides make their case before you tap an answer.
- Type the students' own questions. If a prepared question is close, it is offered. If not, Ask anything answers live, marked "Imagined answer."
- Treat an imagined answer as a conversation starter. Ask, "How could we check that?" and open the book buttons to read the texts.
- Before you leave, make sure every student has a rung and a question for their parents.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Reload the page: it keeps your place. Lost the page? Scan the code above or type the address. No internet? Tell the story in your own words; the rung key on every family table has each character's rung.

DRIVING THE LAPTOP

Space or →	The next line.
← ← Back	Back one step. Nothing is lost.
1 – 9	Choose the group's answer, or a question to ask.
Hear Jacob's answer	After the group has talked it over. Space works too.
Done asking →	When the group runs out of questions.
Type your own…	Offers the closest prepared question. With none, the character answers live, marked "Imagined answer."
Genesis 28:12	Opens the source in Hebrew and English. Esc closes it.
Our rungs	Every rung your group heard. Practice together shows them large, one at a time.
Clear for the next group	Resets the laptop for another group. Tap it twice.

THE LAST FIVE MINUTES

Open Our rungs and tap Practice together. Then each student chooses a rung and the question they will ask their parents.

Send everyone to the family ladders with their rung.

BEFORE THE DAY

- ☐ Charge the laptop, and bring its charger.
- ☐ Open your link in your room ahead of time, to test the Wi-Fi.
- ☐ Turn off sleep and the screen saver.
- ☐ Full screen: F11 on Windows, Control-Command-F on a Mac.
- ☐ With a TV, check the words from the back row.
- ☐ Watch the five-minute walkthrough video, then try a visit.

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VOICES OF THE LADDER · FAMILY LEARNING MORNING

Leader's guide
Parents

Sunday, November 22 · Breakouts 10:00–10:30 · Thirty minutes Room _____

YOUR GROUP'S LINK

techrabbi.org/jacobs-ladder/voices/#parents

Type it on the laptop, or scan it with a phone.

> Every parent leaves with a rung: a line, often in Hebrew, and a question for their child. They will also be ready to receive their child's rung.
>
> *Rambam read the angels on Jacob's ladder as people who climb up to learn and come back down to teach (Guide for the Perplexed 1:15). This morning follows that shape: everyone climbs in their own group, then comes down to teach their family.*

YOUR THIRTY MINUTES

- **10:00** **Welcome.** Your children are climbing too, and soon they will teach you.
- **10:02** **Jacob.** Everyone starts here.
- **10:14** **Isaac.** A parent who sends a child away with a blessing.

  Ahead of time? *If Isaac ends before 10:15, visit Rebekah: a parent who sends a child away to save him.*
- **10:25** **Our rungs,** then how to receive your child's rung.
- **10:30** **Family ladders.** Stay here: your children join you.

Each visit takes ten to twelve minutes and ends with its rung.

TIPS FOR THE PARENTS' GROUP

- Pairs first, then the room. The discussion questions are written for pairs.
- Read the Hebrew aloud together. Many of the parents' rungs are Hebrew lines.
- Typed questions work here too, with an imagined answer when there is no prepared one.
- Isaac's blessing sets up the one you will give your children at the wrap-up.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Reload the page: it keeps your place. Lost the page? Scan the code above or type the address. No internet? Tell the story in your own words; the rung key on every family table has each character's rung.

DRIVING THE LAPTOP

Space or →	The next line.
← ← Back	Back one step. Nothing is lost.
1 – 9	Choose the group's answer, or a question to ask.
Hear Jacob's answer	After the group has talked it over. Space works too.
Done asking →	When the group runs out of questions.
Type your own…	Offers the closest prepared question. With none, the character answers live, marked "Imagined answer."
Genesis 28:12	Opens the source in Hebrew and English. Esc closes it.
Our rungs	Every rung your group heard. Practice together shows them large, one at a time.
Clear for the next group	Resets the laptop for another group. Tap it twice.

THE LAST FIVE MINUTES

Open Our rungs and say each one aloud once. Then prepare to receive your child's rung:

1. Listen all the way through.
2. Say it back, and do the motion with them.
3. Ask them their question, then answer it yourself.
4. Only then, teach them your rung.

Send everyone to the family ladders with their rung.

BEFORE THE DAY

- ☐ Charge the laptop, and bring its charger.
- ☐ Open your link in your room ahead of time, to test the Wi-Fi.
- ☐ Turn off sleep and the screen saver.
- ☐ Full screen: F11 on Windows, Control-Command-F on a Mac.
- ☐ With a TV, check the words from the back row.
- ☐ Watch the five-minute walkthrough video, then try a visit.
- ☐ At 9:30, put the opening screen up in the sanctuary: techrabbi.org/jacobs-ladder/voices/#opening.

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